PHOTOGRAPHS BY IWG/PETER LYONS

Spiral ash (*Fraxinus excelsior*) bowl by Robert O' Connor. He received first place overall as well as the people's choice

Irish seminar onto a winner

Editor **Mark Baker** popped over to Dublin for this year's IWG Seminar and found himself judging an awe-inspiring chapter challenge – as well as enjoying the craic...

With a wide range of turning options, a complicated chapter challenge – see page 54 – and a huge amount of fun, the annual Irish Woodturners Guild's 2015 Seminar proved to be a real success.

Hosted by the same chapter for two consecutive years before moving on to the next town or city, this year's seminar took place from 25 September at the Radisson Blu, Dublin, conveniently located next to the airport. The national seminar is run over three days. It starts just after Friday lunchtime and finishes on Sunday mid-afternoon. There were six demonstration points – conference rooms fitted out with a lathe, sharpening equipment, safety screen, audiovisual equipment, protective sheeting on the floor and comfortable seating – and a trade area large enough to accommodate five stands. There was also a room for the display of turned work, with contributions from both demonstrators and people attending the seminar. The pieces were later categorised and judged in various competition sections.

Away from the work, lunch and dinner were served in a large dining hall, where the main presentations and speeches were also made. I was soon to learn the food was good, the company sound and the work excellent.

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